

July 16

Dear Israel,

Enjoyed your letter & the material on your efforts with alphabets. You flatter me with "Hebrew Type Expert." "Type MAVEN," EFSHER, but on Hebrew... no.

In 1939 I became an apprentice on the Linotype machine... metal type of course... and in 1989 I became an apprentice again... on a Mac II with a Laserwriter NT & AppleScanner! Am probably told you I'm a printer. typographer. designer.

My interest in type lead me to the roots of type which lead to calligraphy... and then on to the study of the history & development of the alphabet. A love of the sounds of Yiddish lead to the Hebrew alphabet and Hebrew type faces & their history. I can read... with vowels... but can not understand IVRIT. Like so many guys of my generation, we learned, in HEDEB, to read, but not speak. My grandchildren put me to shame.

There is very little material, as you ~~prob~~ probably know on Hebrew type. I did have some interesting contact with Dr. Moshe Spitzer before he died. His "The Development of Hebrew Lettering" is OK, but does not go into depth. The types he sponsored are good. I have a few of Henri Friedlaender's articles. Ruben Seaf's book has been reprinted and has a good collection of pen alphabets. For a traditional lettering artist, some of his alphabets are

Contemporary. About the only source for what's happening in Hebrew letterforms is the Israeli Bibliophiles.

Perhaps your company could act as a gathering point for Hebrew calligraphers... or should I say American Jews who do Hebrew calligraphy. One of the best sources for history & development of the Aleph Beth is David Diringer the British Jew who put together the Alphabet Museum in Tel Aviv... I have two of his books.

In my garage... a Vandercook hand proof press, foundry type in cases and wood type, a modest collection of Hebrew fonts, a good size collection of metal borders*, ornaments, etc. You may be wondering, why at my age, the interest in the Mac I teach ^{at} a local ^{state} University, a credit course in typography and design... & also team teach, with a computer whiz-kid, computer graphics.

I'm going to scan my Hebrew calligraphy... use Photographer and develop some alphabets. Want to do the calligraphy on the Mac... make engravings and print letterpress in two colors on the Vandercook. Printing can be in as many colors as I need when done that way.

Which should I get Photographer or the ATF version? Ari said something about the ATF program being an improvement over Photographer?

Do you have samples of Hebrew alphabets from the traditional metal type face foundries... American and European?

*even some in brass!

Of course I'm interested in what you are doing & would like for you to keep in touch.

Zie gezunt

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